

Furman Justice Forum Constitution

Article I: Name

The formal name of this organization shall be “Furman Justice Forum.”

Article II: Purpose

The purpose of the Furman Justice Forum is the following:

To raise awareness of social justice issues on Furman’s Campus through discussions, lectures, and other events. The goal of the organization is to help students at Furman have an opportunity to learn about social injustices, to reflect on these issues, and hopefully feel called to take action on these issues as a result of their increased awareness.

The organization will sponsor lunches/meetings with professors where students will be able to discuss social justice issues. It will also sponsor 1 or more CLPs each semester in order to connect students to prominent scholars and activists who have focused their work on social justice. The hope is that these events will give students an opportunity to take the time to listen and understand issues before they take action to address them.

Article III: Affiliations

The Furman Justice Forum is not directly affiliated with any academic department at Furman. Social justice crosses disciplinary boundaries and will rely on support from faculty members in many different departments. The Furman Justice Forum is an independent organization and is not affiliated with any local, state, or national organizations.

Article IV: Membership

Membership in the Furman Justice Forum shall be afforded to any student who commits to assist with the organization of events and would like to stay up to date with events related to social justice happening around campus. Students may contact a member of the Furman Justice Society leadership board if interested in membership, and will be eligible for joining if they commit to assist with helping execute at least one Furman Justice Forum event each semester. In keeping with Furman University’s non-discrimination policies, membership shall be open to all undergraduate, day students. Our organization will not discriminate on the basis of race, sex, handicap, age, sexual orientation, political affiliation, or religious affiliation.

Article V: Officers

The Furman Justice Forum leadership shall consist of one president, one vice president, and a board of other officers.

- I. President: The president is tasked with overseeing the operations of the organization and establishing partnerships with professors, external speakers, and setting the agenda for each year/semester.
- II. Vice President: This position will assist the president in all duties and attend or lead all events and meetings that the president is not able to attend. In the event of the president's absence, this individual will operate as an "acting president" until their return.
- III. Treasurer: This position shall be tasked with fundraising for events and managing the FJF budget. They may specifically be tasked with organizing the budget for Justice Month but may appoint (in consultation with the president) an assistant treasurer specifically for Justice Month.
- IV. Secretary: This position will assist the president with deciding the agenda for each semester/year, as well as taking attendance and minutes during in person meetings.
- V. Event Coordinators: These individuals, the number dependent on total membership and interest in the position, will collaborate to plan events throughout the semester. They will build a network with other Furman organizations and students, envision plans for speakers and events. The leadership board should always be in consultation with the members of the organization about ideas for events and speakers.
- VI. Social Media Manager: This position will manage the club's social media and community presence. They will be tasked with the marketing of events, sharing events with the campus community, and putting posters and other promotional material around campus.

Article VI: Advisor

The advisor shall be a faculty or staff member who has a demonstrated interest in social justice issues. They may come from any department so long as they have demonstrated such an interest. They will be consultants for speakers and events and offer suggestions to the leadership team. They will have no formal role in decision-making, but will provide support and advice.

Article VII: Meetings

The organization will not have formal in-person meetings (as students involved will have various other weekly commitments), but there will be lunches with faculty members and events that members should attend in order to maintain membership (they must attend and offer support for at least 1 of these meetings each month pursuant to Article IV).

Article VIII: Finance

In addition to the SGA allotment of money, the organization shall receive funding for events from various grants and co-sponsorships with academic departments and outside organizations.

Article XI: Amendments

To Amend the constitution, there must be a petition from an individual member for a change, and this must be followed by a unanimous approval of the proposed change by the members of the organization.

BYLAWS

Article I: Membership

- I. Categories of Members: Anyone who commits to support the mission of the organization and assist with one event per semester shall be a member. There will be no “categories of members.”
- II. Applications: The application process for membership will include a brief meeting/interview with the leadership team to discuss the applicant’s willingness to support the mission of the organization by assisting with one event per semester. The leadership team will determine if said individual is a good fit for membership. Membership is designed to not be selective and should be offered to anyone willing to assist with the organization’s objectives.
- III. Financial Obligations: There are no financial obligations for membership.
- IV. Removing a Member: To remove a member, there must be a petition by another member based on a grievance. There shall be a hearing with the leadership board who will then determine if membership should be terminated. The faculty advisor will offer advice and serve as a consultant on the matter, but will not have any decision-making power.

Article II: Selection of Officers

Pursuant to Article V of the Constitution, there shall be a president and a vice president who are selected through an application and voting process during the fall semester. Their term will begin once the term of the current leadership ends in December. Please refer to Article V for information about office duties.

- I. Removal of Officers: To impeach an officer, there must be a 90% vote by the current members, they may petition amongst themselves and bring the petition to the leadership team and advisor to carry out the order of impeachment. There shall be a hearing amongst a committee of 5 student members selected to serve as judiciaries if the leader disputes his order of impeachment.

- II. Filing a vacancy: to fill a vacant leadership, a member shall be appointed by the president.

Article III: Selection of Advisor

The leadership team shall select the advisor. The leadership team may renew the position of advisor each year and select the same or a new advisor. The leadership team shall determine if the advisor needs to be removed and will consult amongst themselves in making the change in a generous and understanding manner.

Article IV: Committees

Because of the size of the organization, there should not be many different committees formed. However, to form a committee, a member may make a petition that must be affirmed by a unanimous vote. The organization will not have committees to start, but as it evolves these may emerge. Each year, committees shall come up for renewal and the leadership shall term which committees to keep and which to annul.

Article V: Rules of Order

- I. Internal Business shall be conducted via meetings amongst the leadership team and discussions with the members in terms of planning events and setting the agenda. When members have ideas or complaints, they shall approach the leadership team with recommendations.
- II. Internal conflicts shall be resolved through a dispute settlement board which will be appointed by members (with a 75% approval vote) and the leadership team. Any person may appoint the 5 person dispute settlement board, and the members shall then vote on to approve the board.

Article VI: Amending the Bylaws

To amend the bylaws, there must be a petition for amendment and a 75% vote by members in order to confirm the amendment.

Last updated before the 2025-2026 academic year.